Phase 4: Kings & Kingdoms

Israel asks for a king, and God shows that He is the true King, and that the best King of all is still coming.

At a Glance	
Month	Month 4
Books covered	1 Samuel, 2 Samuel, 1 Kings, 2 Kings, 1 Chronicles, 2 Chronicles (**6 books**)
Bible section(s)	History (books 9–14 of the Bible; books 4–9 of the 12 History books)
Big Idea	God looks at the heart. Kings come and go, but God's promise of a forever King never fails.
Memory Verse (all ages)	"People look at the outward appearance, but the LORD looks at the heart." (1 Samuel 16:7, NIV)
Little Lambs verse	"The LORD looks at the heart." (1 Samuel 16:7)
Theme color	Royal purple (with gold trim)
Phase symbol / badge	A gold crown with a small red heart in the middle (the "Heart Crown" badge)
Running total of books learned	**14 of 66** (Law 5 + History 9 of 12)

The Big Idea (in kid words)

God's people said, "We want a king like everybody else!" God gave them kings. Some kings loved God and some did not. God does not pick people because they are tall, strong or good-looking. He looks at the heart. God made a promise to King David: "Someone from your family will be King forever."

How this points to Jesus: Jesus is that forever King! He was born in Bethlehem, King David's hometown, and He is called the "Son of David" (Matthew 1:1). Every king in these books messed up somehow, even the good ones. Jesus is the perfect King who never does wrong, who fought the biggest giant (sin and death) for us, and whose kingdom will never end (Luke 1:32–33).

The Books in Easy Words

> Teacher tip: Say the numbers out loud as words: "**First** Samuel," "**Second** Kings." Show the number with your fingers (1 finger, then 2 fingers). Explain that these were once one long book each, split into two scrolls because they were too long to fit on one.

1. 1 Samuel

- **How to say it:** "FIRST SAM-yoo-ul"
- **How to spell it:** Sam-u-el, S-A-M-U-E-L (with the number 1 in front)
- **Section:** History
- **Traditional author:** Samuel wrote the early part. The prophets Nathan and Gad probably added more (1 Chronicles 29:29). We don't know who put the book together in its final form.
- **One-sentence kid summary:** God gives Israel a prophet named Samuel, then their first king, Saul, who stops obeying, so God chooses a shepherd boy named David whose heart loves God.
- **In one word:** *Chosen*
- **Key people:** Hannah, Eli, Samuel, Saul, David, Jonathan, Goliath
- **Key stories:** Hannah prays for a baby (ch. 1); God calls young Samuel in the night (ch. 3); Israel asks for a king (ch. 8); Saul becomes king (ch. 9–10); David is anointed (ch. 16); David and Goliath (ch. 17); David and Jonathan's friendship (ch. 18–20); David spares Saul's life (ch. 24, 26)
- **Where Jesus shows up:** David is anointed with oil. "Messiah" and "Christ" both mean "Anointed One." Like David, Jesus was chosen by God and faced the giant enemy for His people. Hannah's song (ch. 2) sounds a lot like Mary's song (Luke 1:46–55).
- **Hand motion / picture symbol:** 👂 Cup a hand behind your ear, because Samuel said "Speak, for your servant is listening" (1 Samuel 3:10). Picture: a sling and five smooth stones.

2. 2 Samuel

- **How to say it:** "SEC-und SAM-yoo-ul"
- **How to spell it:** Sam-u-el, S-A-M-U-E-L (with the number 2 in front)
- **Section:** History
- **Traditional author:** Not named. Tradition says Nathan and Gad, prophets in David's court, recorded these events.
- **One-sentence kid summary:** David becomes king, God promises him a forever kingdom, David sins badly and is sorry, and his family has big troubles.
- **In one word:** *Promise*
- **Key people:** David, Mephibosheth, Bathsheba, Nathan the prophet, Absalom, Joab
- **Key stories:** David becomes king of Judah, then of all Israel (ch. 2, 5); David captures Jerusalem (ch. 5); David dances as the ark comes to Jerusalem (ch. 6); God's forever promise to David (ch. 7); kindness to Mephibosheth, who could not walk (ch. 9); David's sin and Nathan's story of the lamb (ch. 11–12); Absalom rebels against his father (ch. 15–18)
- **Where Jesus shows up:** 2 Samuel 7:16, "Your throne will be established forever." Jesus is the Son of David who sits on that forever throne. The way David brought Mephibosheth to eat at the king's table is a picture of how Jesus welcomes us.
- **Hand motion / picture symbol:** 🤝 Make a pinky promise with a friend for God's promise to David. Picture: a throne with a "forever" sign (∞).

3. 1 Kings

- **How to say it:** "FIRST KINGZ"
- **How to spell it:** Kings, K-I-N-G-S (with the number 1 in front)
- **Section:** History

- **Traditional author:** Not named. Jewish tradition says the prophet Jeremiah. The writer used older royal records ("the book of the annals of the kings").
- **One-sentence kid summary:** Wise King Solomon builds God's temple, then the kingdom splits in two, and the brave prophet Elijah shows that the LORD is the only true God.
- **In one word:** *Divided*
- **Key people:** Solomon, the Queen of Sheba, Rehoboam, Jeroboam, Ahab, Jezebel, Elijah, the widow of Zarephath
- **Key stories:** Solomon asks God for wisdom (ch. 3); the two mothers and the baby (ch. 3); Solomon builds the temple (ch. 6–8); the Queen of Sheba visits (ch. 10); Solomon's heart turns away (ch. 11); the kingdom splits into Israel (north) and Judah (south) (ch. 12); ravens feed Elijah (ch. 17); fire from heaven on Mount Carmel (ch. 18); God speaks in a gentle whisper (ch. 19)
- **Where Jesus shows up:** Jesus said, "Now something greater than Solomon is here" (Matthew 12:42). Jesus is the true Temple, the place where God lives with people (John 2:19–21). Elijah raised a widow's son (ch. 17), and Jesus raised a widow's son too (Luke 7:11–17).
- **Hand motion / picture symbol:** 👑✂️ Put a "crown" on your head with both hands, then make a scissors motion to "split" the kingdom. Picture: a crown split down the middle.

4. 2 Kings

- **How to say it:** "SEC-und KINGZ"
- **How to spell it:** Kings, K-I-N-G-S (with the number 2 in front)
- **Section:** History
- **Traditional author:** Not named. Jewish tradition says Jeremiah, the same writer as 1 Kings.
- **One-sentence kid summary:** Elisha does amazing miracles, most of the kings stop following God, and both kingdoms are finally taken away to faraway lands, just as God warned.
- **In one word:** *Warning*
- **Key people:** Elijah, Elisha, Naaman, the Shunammite woman, Joash (boy king at 7), Hezekiah, Josiah (boy king at 8)
- **Key stories:** Elijah goes to heaven in a whirlwind (ch. 2); the widow's oil keeps pouring (ch. 4); Elisha raises the Shunammite boy (ch. 4); Naaman is healed after dipping 7 times in the Jordan (ch. 5); the floating axe head (ch. 6); chariots of fire around Elisha (ch. 6); Israel falls to Assyria (ch. 17); Hezekiah prays (ch. 18–20); Josiah finds God's lost Book (ch. 22–23); Jerusalem falls to Babylon (ch. 25)
- **Where Jesus shows up:** Elisha fed 100 men with 20 loaves and had leftovers (2 Kings 4:42–44). Jesus fed 5,000 with five loaves! Jesus Himself talked about Naaman (Luke 4:27). The book ends with a king of David's family still alive in Babylon (25:27–30), so God's promise is not dead.
- **Hand motion / picture symbol:** 🌪️ Spin your finger in the air like a whirlwind (Elijah goes up!). Picture: a chariot of fire.

5. 1 Chronicles

- **How to say it:** "FIRST KRON-ih-kulz"
- **How to spell it:** Chron-i-cles, C-H-R-O-N-I-C-L-E-S (with the number 1 in front). Tip: the "Ch" sounds like "K"!
- **Section:** History
- **Traditional author:** Jewish tradition says Ezra the priest-scribe. Often just called "the Chronicler."

- **One-sentence kid summary:** A family-tree book that starts with Adam and retells King David's story, showing how David got everything ready for God's temple.
- **In one word:** *Remember*
- **Key people:** Adam (first name in the book!), Jabez, David, the Levites (worship leaders), Solomon
- **Key stories:** Long family trees from Adam to the return from exile (ch. 1–9); the prayer of Jabez (4:9–10); David brings the ark to Jerusalem with music and joy (ch. 13, 15–16); God's promise to David (ch. 17); David collects supplies and makes plans for the temple (ch. 22, 28–29)
- **Where Jesus shows up:** The family trees lead to David's family, and Matthew 1 continues that same family tree all the way to Jesus! God's promise in 1 Chronicles 17:12–14 ("I will establish his throne forever") is fulfilled in Jesus.
- **Hand motion / picture symbol:** 📜 Pretend to unroll a long scroll (a long family tree!). Picture: a tree with names on its branches.

6. 2 Chronicles

- **How to say it:** "SEC-und KRON-ih-kulz"
- **How to spell it:** Chron-i-cles, C-H-R-O-N-I-C-L-E-S (with the number 2 in front)
- **Section:** History
- **Traditional author:** Jewish tradition says Ezra (the Chronicler)
- **One-sentence kid summary:** The story of Solomon's temple and the kings of Judah, and how God always forgave when His people humbled themselves and prayed.
- **In one word:** *Return*
- **Key people:** Solomon, Jehoshaphat, Joash, Hezekiah, Josiah, Cyrus king of Persia
- **Key stories:** Solomon dedicates the temple and fire falls from heaven (ch. 5–7); "If my people... will humble themselves and pray" (7:14); Jehoshaphat's choir marches in front of the army, "the battle is not yours, but God's" (ch. 20); Hezekiah's big Passover party (ch. 30); Josiah's reforms (ch. 34–35); Babylon destroys the temple (ch. 36); King Cyrus says, "Go home and rebuild!" (36:22–23)
- **Where Jesus shows up:** The temple was where God met His people. Jesus is "God with us" (Matthew 1:23). In the Hebrew Bible, 2 Chronicles is the very last book, and it ends by looking forward to going home, which Jesus makes possible forever.
- **Hand motion / picture symbol:** 🙏 Fold your hands in prayer and bow (2 Chronicles 7:14). Picture: Solomon's temple with fire on top.

> **The "twin books" trick:** All three pairs are twins. **Samuel** = the prophet who anointed the first kings. **Kings** = the kings after David. **Chronicles** = the replay (re-telling) with a focus on worship and the temple. Kids can remember: "**S**am, **K**ings, **C**hron: **S**tart, **K**eep going, **C**atch up!"

Teacher Preparation

Background for the teacher

These six books cover about 500 years, from roughly 1100 BC (the last judge, Samuel) to 586 BC (Jerusalem destroyed by Babylon) and, in the last two verses of 2 Chronicles, 538 BC (Cyrus lets the Jews go home).

- **1–2 Samuel** describe the change from judges to kings. In 1 Samuel 8 the people ask for a king "such as all the other nations have." God warns them through Samuel, then gives them Saul. Saul looks the part (tall, handsome), but he disobeys (ch. 13, 15). God sends Samuel to anoint David, the youngest of Jesse's sons (ch. 16). Much of 1 Samuel is about David running from a jealous Saul. In 2 Samuel, David becomes king (about 1010 BC), makes Jerusalem the capital, and receives God's covenant promise (2 Samuel 7), which is one of the most important chapters in the Old Testament. David then sins with Bathsheba and arranges the death of her husband Uriah (ch. 11). He repents when the prophet Nathan confronts him (ch. 12; see Psalm 51), but serious consequences follow in his family.
- **1–2 Kings** begin with Solomon (about 970–930 BC), who builds the temple and is famous for wisdom, but whose many foreign wives turn his heart to idols (1 Kings 11). After his death the kingdom divides (about 930 BC): **Israel** in the north (10 tribes, capital eventually Samaria) and **Judah** in the south (capital Jerusalem, kings from David's line). Every northern king is described as doing evil. Judah has a mix of good and bad kings. Prophets like **Elijah** and **Elisha** confront kings and call people back to God. Israel falls to **Assyria** in 722 BC (2 Kings 17). Judah falls to **Babylon**, and Jerusalem and the temple are destroyed in 586 BC (2 Kings 25).
- **1–2 Chronicles** were written later, after the exile, to people who had come back home. They retell the same history but focus on David's family, the temple, worship, and the pattern that when people humble themselves and seek God, He restores them. The Chronicler leaves out many of David's and Solomon's failures, not to hide them (they were already in Samuel–Kings) but to encourage a discouraged people with God's faithfulness.

Key truths to emphasize

1. **God is the true King.** Even when Israel wanted a human king, God was still in charge (1 Samuel 8:7; 12:12).
2. **God looks at the heart** (1 Samuel 16:7). Obedience matters more than looks, size, or impressive sacrifices (1 Samuel 15:22).
3. **God keeps His promises.** The promise to David (2 Samuel 7) stays alive even when the kingdom falls.
4. **Sin has consequences, but God forgives the humble** (2 Samuel 12; 2 Chronicles 7:14).
5. **Jesus is the forever King from David's family**, better than Saul, David or Solomon.

Timeline and map notes

- Draw a simple timeline on a long strip of butcher paper and add to it each week: `Samuel (judge/prophet) → Saul (1st king) → David → Solomon → SPLIT (930 BC) → Israel falls (722 BC) / Judah falls (586 BC) → Cyrus: go home! (538 BC)`

- Map: Show Bethlehem (David's hometown), the Valley of Elah (David and Goliath), Jerusalem (City of David, temple), Mount Carmel (Elijah), the Jordan River (Naaman), Samaria (northern capital), Assyria (Nineveh) to the northeast, and Babylon to the east.
- Show the split with two colors: blue for Israel (north), purple for Judah (south). The southern kingdom was called Judah after the tribe of Judah, and that is where the word "Jew" comes from.

Handling sensitive content by age

Topic	Little Lambs (4–6)	Explorers (7–10)	Trailblazers (11–13)	Ambassadors (14–17)
Goliath's death	"David won, and the giant fell down."	"David's stone hit Goliath and he fell. God gave David the win."	Read 1 Samuel 17 as written. Discuss why the battle mattered.	Discuss ancient warfare and representative combat (one champion fights for the whole army).
David & Bathsheba	"David did something very wrong. He said sorry to God, and God forgave him."	"David took another man's wife and caused that man to die. God sent Nathan to tell him the truth. David was truly sorry (Psalm 51)."	Same as Explorers, with Nathan's parable read aloud (2 Samuel 12:1–7).	Discuss abuse of power, honesty about heroes, repentance vs. consequences.
Wars & kings killed	Skip details.	"There were many battles. Some kings were very bad."	Brief facts as they come up.	Discuss God's judgment and patience (He warned for centuries).
Jezebel, Baal worship	"Some people prayed to fake gods."	"Baal was a fake god. God showed He is the real God."	Explain Baal worship and why Elijah's challenge mattered.	Note that 1 Kings 18:40 records the prophets of Baal being killed; discuss covenant law and why Christians don't take up swords for God today (John 18:36).
The fall of Jerusalem	"Because the people kept doing wrong, they had to move far away. God still loved them."	"God warned many times. Babylon came and took them away. God promised they would come home."	Connect to Jeremiah and Daniel (coming in Phase 7).	Discuss exile as a theme (BibleProject "Exile" video).

Common kid questions (with simple answers)

- **"Was Goliath really a giant?"** The Bible says he was over 9 feet tall (1 Samuel 17:4) in most Hebrew copies. Either way he was huge, and David was a boy. The point is: God is bigger.
- **"Why did God let them have a king if it was a bad idea?"** The problem wasn't having a king. God had planned a king (Deuteronomy 17:14–20). The problem was that they wanted a king *instead* of trusting God. God gave them what they asked for and still worked it into His plan.
- **"Why did God choose David if David did bad things later?"** God doesn't choose perfect people (there aren't any!). David's heart kept coming back to God. When he sinned, he admitted it and asked for forgiveness.

- **"Is Elijah still alive?"** Elijah was taken to heaven without dying (2 Kings 2:11). He appeared with Moses when Jesus was transfigured (Matthew 17:3), so he is alive with God.
- **"Why are there two books with the same name?"** They were one long book that got split into two scrolls. Ask: "Have you ever had a book with Part 1 and Part 2?"
- **"Why does Chronicles repeat Kings?"** It's like watching the replay of a game from a different camera angle. It shows us new things.

Month at a Glance

Week	Passage	Lesson Title	Key Point	📺 Video	🎮 Game	🖍️ Activity
1	1 Samuel 3; 8–10; 16	God Looks at the Heart	God calls Samuel and picks David because of his heart.	SharefaithKids "Samuel"; BibleJourneyTV "Samuel"; BibleProject "Overview: 1 Samuel"	Crown Grab	Heart Crown craft
2	1 Samuel 17; 2 Samuel 5, 7, 9	Giant Faith & a Forever Promise	God fights for us and keeps His forever promise.	SharefaithKids "David and Goliath"; BibleJourneyTV "David and Goliath"; BibleProject "Overview: 2 Samuel"	Giant Toss	Five Smooth Stones verse stones
3	1 Kings 3; 8; 12; 18	Wise King, Split Kingdom, Fire from Heaven	Ask God for wisdom; the LORD is the only true God.	SharefaithKids "Elijah"; BibleJourneyTV "Elijah Mount Carmel"; BibleProject "Overview: 1-2 Kings"	Kingdom Split Tag	Elijah's 12-Stone Altar
4	2 Kings 2; 5; 22–23; 2 Chronicles 7:14; 36:22–23	Prophets, Boy Kings & God's Replay Book	God keeps working and keeps His promises, even when kings fail.	SharefaithKids "Naaman"; BibleJourneyTV "Elisha"; BibleProject "Overview: Chronicles"	Seven Dips Relay	King Timeline Scroll
5 (optional)	Review of all six books	Royal Review Day	Jesus is the forever King.	Rewatch favorite clip	Throne Swap + Royal Bible Bowl	Royal Feast & badge ceremony

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Weekly Lessons

Week 1: God Looks at the Heart

Scripture: 1 Samuel 3:1–10; 8:4–7; 10:23–24; 16:1–13

Lesson goal: Kids will learn that God speaks, that Israel asked for a king, and that God chooses people by looking at their hearts, not their outsides.

Opening hook / object lesson (5 min) *Supplies:* Two boxes. One is beautifully gift-wrapped with a bow but has trash inside (crumpled paper, a banana peel in a bag). The other is a plain brown paper bag with something wonderful inside (a wrapped treat for each child, or a shiny toy crown).

1. Hold up both. Ask, "Which one do you want?" (Most pick the pretty box.)
2. Open the pretty box: trash! Open the plain bag: treasure!
3. Say: "The outside didn't tell us what was inside. Today we'll learn that God doesn't look at the outside. He looks at the heart."

📖 **Story script (read aloud)**

> A long time ago, a woman named Hannah prayed and prayed for a baby. God answered her prayer, and she named her son **Samuel**. When Samuel was still a boy, he went to live at God's house to help the old priest, Eli.
>
> One night, Samuel was lying down when he heard a voice: "Samuel!" He jumped up and ran to Eli. "Here I am!" But Eli said, "I didn't call you. Go back to bed." This happened again... and again! Three times! Then Eli understood. "It's God calling you. Next time, say, 'Speak, LORD, for your servant is listening.'" So Samuel did. And God talked to Samuel. Samuel grew up to be God's prophet, a person who tells people God's messages.
>
> When Samuel was old, the people came to him and said, "Give us a king, like all the other nations have!" That made Samuel sad. God told him, "They are not turning away from you. They are turning away from Me as their King." But God let them have a king.
>
> The first king was **Saul**. Saul was tall, taller than everyone, and handsome. He *looked* like a king! But Saul did not obey God. He did things his own way.
>
> So God sent Samuel to Bethlehem, to a man named Jesse who had eight sons. The oldest son walked in. He was tall and strong. Samuel thought, "This must be the one!" But God said, "**People look at the outward appearance, but the LORD looks at the heart.**" One by one, seven sons walked by. God said no to each one.
>
> "Do you have any more sons?" Samuel asked. "Well, there's the youngest," said Jesse. "He's out taking care of the sheep." They sent for him. In came a young shepherd boy named **David**. God said, "This is the one!" Samuel poured oil on David's head to show that God had chosen him to be the next king.
>
> David wasn't the biggest or the oldest. But his heart loved God. And God was looking at his heart. God sees your heart too, and He loves you.

Age-group teaching tips

- **Little Lambs:** Act out Samuel "sleeping" and jumping up three times. Have kids say "Here I am!" each time. Use a bottle of (water) "oil" to pretend-anoint a doll or stuffed sheep.
- **Explorers:** Count Jesse's sons on fingers (7 walk by + David = 8). Have kids find 1 Samuel in their Bibles (right after Ruth).
- **Trailblazers:** Read 1 Samuel 8:10–18 (what a king would take) and 1 Samuel 15:22 ("to obey is better than sacrifice"). Ask why Saul's outward religion wasn't enough.
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss 1 Samuel 8:7: how does wanting to "be like everyone else" still pull at us? Have them lead the object lesson for Little Lambs.

💬 **Discussion questions**

- *Little Lambs:* 1) Who called Samuel in the night? (God) 2) What job did David have? (Shepherd) 3) What does God look at? (Our heart)
- *Explorers:* 1) How many times did God call Samuel before he answered? (3, then a 4th time he answered) 2) Why did God not choose David's oldest brother? 3) What is a way you can "listen" to God this week?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) What was wrong with the people's reason for wanting a king (8:5, 20)? 2) Compare Saul and David: what did each look like on the outside and inside? 3) What do people today judge others by on the outside?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) What does "anointed" mean, and how does it connect to the titles "Messiah" and "Christ"? 2) Saul offered sacrifices but disobeyed. How can church activity hide a heart problem? 3) If God looks at the heart, how should that change the way you post online or choose friends?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "Samuel" / "God calls Samuel" / "David anointed" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Samuel | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Samuel" / "King Saul" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Samuel | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors (Explorers with pauses) | Likely title: "Overview: 1 Samuel" | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=1+Samuel |

Follow-up questions: 1) What did the video show about why Israel wanted a king? 2) What did you notice about how God chose David?

> Preview every video first. Choose the clip that fits your time (about 10 minutes); show only part of a longer video if needed.

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Crown Grab* (see Games). Use the 14 book names learned so far.

✂️ **Activity of the week:** *Heart Crown craft* (see Activities & Crafts).

🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** Spell S-A-M-U-E-L. Learn "First Samuel, Second Samuel" with 1 and 2 fingers. Little Lambs: "The LORD looks at the heart" with motions (point up, point to eyes, hands make a heart).

🙏 **Closing prayer**

> Dear God, thank You that You see my heart. Help me listen to You like Samuel did. Make my heart love You like David's. In Jesus' name, amen.

Week 2: Giant Faith & a Forever Promise

Scripture: 1 Samuel 17; 2 Samuel 5:1–5; 7:12–16; 9:1–13

Lesson goal: Kids will learn that David trusted God to fight Goliath, that God promised David a forever King, and that David showed kindness like God does.

Opening hook / object lesson *Supplies:* A tape measure, painter's tape, and a picture of a person.

1. Before class, put a strip of tape on the wall at 9 feet 9 inches (about 3 meters), close to the ceiling. (Most Hebrew copies of 1 Samuel 17:4 say "six cubits and a span," about 9 feet 9 inches.)
2. Have kids stand against the wall to compare. Ask, "Would you want to fight someone this tall?"
3. Say: "One boy did, and he wasn't scared, because he knew God was bigger."

📖 **Story script**

> The army of Israel was camped on one hill. The Philistine army was camped on the other. In the valley between them stood a giant named **Goliath**. He was super tall, he wore heavy armor, and he carried a spear as thick as a fence post. Every morning and every evening for forty days, he shouted, "Send someone to fight me!" All of Israel's soldiers, even King Saul, were scared.
>
> One day, David, the young shepherd, came to bring food to his big brothers. He heard Goliath shouting. "Who is this man who makes fun of the army of the living God?" David asked. "I will fight him!"
>
> King Saul said, "You're just a boy!" But David said, "When I watched my sheep, God helped me fight a lion and a bear. God will help me fight this giant too."
>
> Saul gave David his armor, but it was too big and heavy. So David took it off. He took his shepherd's staff, his sling, and five smooth stones from a stream.
>
> Goliath laughed at him. But David shouted, "You come against me with a sword and spear, but I come against you in the name of the LORD! The battle is the LORD's!" David ran toward Goliath, put a stone in his sling, swung it around, and let it fly. *Thunk!* The stone hit Goliath's forehead, and the giant fell face down on the ground. God gave Israel the victory!
>
> Years later, David became king. God made David an amazing promise: "Someone from your family will be King forever. His kingdom will never end."
>
> King David remembered his best friend Jonathan, who had died. "Is anyone left from Jonathan's family that I can be kind to?" Someone told him about Jonathan's son, **Mephibosheth** (meff-IB-oh-sheth), whose feet had been hurt so he couldn't walk. Mephibosheth was afraid, but David said, "Don't be afraid. You will eat at my table like one of my sons, always."

> Many years later, the forever King came from David's family. His name is **Jesus**! He beat the biggest giants, sin and death, and He invites us to eat at His table forever.

Age-group teaching tips

- **Little Lambs:** Let them stomp like Goliath and then "fall down." Give each child five "smooth stones" (cotton balls) to toss into a basket.
- **Explorers:** Have them find 1 and 2 Samuel and notice the chapters (1 Samuel 17 is a long chapter: 58 verses!). Practice spelling "Goliath."
- **Trailblazers:** Read 2 Samuel 7:12–16 aloud and then Luke 1:32–33. Have them list the matching words (throne, kingdom, forever).
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss "the battle is the LORD's" (1 Samuel 17:47). Is this a promise that we'll win every fight? (No. It means God's purposes win, and we trust Him.) Talk briefly about David's later sin with Bathsheba and Psalm 51: heroes in the Bible are real people who need grace.

💬 **Discussion questions**

- *Little Lambs:* 1) Who was the giant? (Goliath) 2) How many stones did David pick up? (5) 3) Who helped David? (God)
- *Explorers:* 1) Why didn't David wear Saul's armor? 2) What did God promise David? 3) How was David kind to Mephibosheth?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) What "practice" had David had trusting God before Goliath? 2) What "giants" do kids your age face? 3) How does Mephibosheth's story show us grace?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) Why is 2 Samuel 7 called the "Davidic covenant," and why does the whole Bible care about it? 2) David is the hero against Goliath, but in a sense we are more like the scared soldiers and Jesus is like David. What does that change? 3) How do you hold together that David was "a man after God's own heart" and also a man who sinned badly?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "David and Goliath" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=David+and+Goliath | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "David and Goliath" / "King David" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=David+and+Goliath | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors | Likely title: "Overview: 2 Samuel"; bonus theme video "The Messiah" | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=2+Samuel |

Follow-up questions: 1) What gave David courage? 2) What did God promise David's family?

> Preview every video first. BibleProject's 2 Samuel overview mentions David's sin with Bathsheba; it is handled with care but decide which groups should watch.

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Giant Toss* (see Games)

✂️ **Activity of the week:** *Five Smooth Stones* verse stones (see Activities & Crafts)

🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** Review 1 and 2 Samuel. Explorers spell G-O-L-I-A-T-H and D-A-V-I-D. Recite the whole memory verse with motions.

🙏 **Closing prayer**

> God, You are bigger than any giant. Help me be brave and trust You. Thank You for Jesus, the forever King. Amen.

Week 3: Wise King, Split Kingdom, Fire from Heaven

Scripture: 1 Kings 3:5–15; 8:10–11; 12:16–20; 18:20–39

Lesson goal: Kids will learn that Solomon asked for wisdom and built the temple, that the kingdom split in two, and that God showed Elijah and everyone that He alone is the true God.

Opening hook / object lesson *Supplies:* A paper crown, scissors, and a "wish" card.

1. Ask: "If God said, 'Ask for anything you want,' what would you ask for?" Let kids answer (toys, pets, money...).
2. Say: "God really said this to King Solomon! Let's see what he asked for."
3. Later in the lesson, cut the paper crown in half to show the kingdom splitting.

📖 **Story script**

> After King David died, his son **Solomon** became king. One night God came to Solomon in a dream and said, "Ask for whatever you want me to give you."
>
> Solomon could have asked for riches or a long life. Instead, he said, "I'm young and I don't know how to lead all these people. Please give me a wise heart so I can tell right from wrong." God was so pleased! He said, "I will give you wisdom, and I will also give you riches and honor."
>
> Solomon built a beautiful **temple** for God in Jerusalem, made of stone, cedar wood and gold. When it was finished, God's glory filled it like a bright cloud! But later, when Solomon was old, he married many wives who prayed to fake gods, and his heart turned away from the LORD.
>
> After Solomon died, the kingdom split in two, like this crown. *(Cut the crown.)* Ten tribes in the north were called **Israel**. Two tribes in the south were called **Judah**. Many of the kings who came after did evil.
>
> One of the worst was King **Ahab**, and his wife **Jezebel**. They led people to pray to a fake god named **Baal**. So God sent a brave prophet named **Elijah**. Elijah said, "Let's have a contest on Mount Carmel! The 450 prophets of Baal will build an altar, and I will build an altar. Whoever answers with fire is the real God!"
>
> The prophets of Baal danced and shouted from morning until noon. "Baal, answer us!" Nothing happened. Elijah teased them, "Shout louder! Maybe he's asleep!" They shouted all afternoon. Still

> nothing.
>
> Then Elijah built an altar with 12 stones. He dug a ditch around it. Then he said, "Pour water on it!" They poured big jars of water, three times, until the wood was soaked and the ditch was full. Elijah prayed a simple prayer: "LORD, show everyone that You are God."
>
> **WHOOSH!** Fire fell from heaven! It burned up the sacrifice, the wood, the stones, and even licked up the water in the ditch! All the people fell on their faces and shouted, "**The LORD — He is God! The LORD — He is God!**"
>
> Fake gods can't hear us. But the real God hears even a short, simple prayer, and He answers.

Age-group teaching tips

- **Little Lambs:** Have the "Baal prophets" (teachers) jump and shout while nothing happens, then everyone shouts "WHOOSH!" and waves orange/red streamers for the fire. Chant "The LORD, He is God!"
- **Explorers:** Hold up 12 fingers (with a friend) for the 12 stones = 12 tribes. Discuss why Elijah poured water on the altar.
- **Trailblazers:** Map the split kingdom: north = Israel (capital Samaria), south = Judah (capital Jerusalem). Read 1 Kings 18:21: "How long will you waver between two opinions?"
- **Ambassadors:** Compare Solomon's request (1 Kings 3) with James 1:5. Discuss: how can someone so wise make such foolish choices (1 Kings 11:4)? Wisdom must be lived, not just known.

💬 **Discussion questions**

- *Little Lambs:* 1) What did Solomon ask God for? (Wisdom / to be wise) 2) What fell from heaven? (Fire) 3) Who is the real God? (The LORD)
- *Explorers:* 1) Why was asking for wisdom a good choice? 2) What were the two kingdoms called? 3) Why did Baal not answer?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) Why did the kingdom split (1 Kings 11:9–13; 12:13–16)? 2) What did the 12 stones stand for? 3) What are "fake gods" people chase today?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) What does "wavering between two opinions" look like for a teen today? 2) Elijah's prayer was short; the Baal prophets' was long and loud. What does that say about prayer? 3) How is Jesus "greater than Solomon" (Matthew 12:42)?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "Elijah" / "Elijah and the prophets of Baal" / "Solomon" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Elijah | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Elijah Mount Carmel" / "Solomon" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Elijah | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors | Likely title: "Overview: 1-2 Kings" (one video covers both books) | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Kings |

Follow-up questions: 1) What happened after Solomon died? 2) What did the people shout when the fire fell?

> Preview every video first.

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Kingdom Split Tag* (see Games)

✂️ **Activity of the week:** *Elijah's 12-Stone Altar* (see Activities & Crafts)

🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** Spell K-I-N-G-S. Say "First Kings, Second Kings" with the crown motion. Add these to the song.

🙏 **Closing prayer**

> LORD, You are the one true God! Please give me a wise heart like You gave Solomon. Help me follow only You. Amen.

Week 4: Prophets, Boy Kings & God's Replay Book

Scripture: 2 Kings 2:11; 5:1–15; 22:1–2, 8–13; 25:8–11; 1 Chronicles 17:11–14; 2 Chronicles 7:14; 36:22–23

Lesson goal: Kids will learn that God worked through Elisha, used boy kings who loved Him, warned His people, and kept His promise even when they were taken away. They'll learn that Chronicles is the "replay" of the story.

Opening hook / object lesson *Supplies:* A dusty old book (or a Bible wrapped in an old towel and hidden in a box), a damp cloth.

1. Before class, hide the "lost book" somewhere in the room.
2. Say, "Someone lost a very important book! Can you find it?" Let kids search.
3. When found, say: "A long time ago, God's people lost God's Book, inside God's own temple! An 8-year-old king was ruling when they found it. Let's hear what happened."

📖 **Story script**

> Before Elijah went to heaven, he had a helper named **Elisha**. One day, as they walked, a chariot of fire with horses of fire came between them, and Elijah went up to heaven in a whirlwind! Elisha became God's next prophet.
>
> In the land of Aram lived a strong army captain named **Naaman**. But Naaman had a terrible skin disease called leprosy. A young girl from Israel, who had been taken captive and worked in his house, said, "I wish my master would see the prophet in Israel. He would heal him!"
>
> So Naaman rode to Elisha's house with horses, chariots and gifts. Elisha didn't even come outside! He sent a message: "Go wash seven times in the Jordan River, and you'll be healed." Naaman was angry. "That muddy river? We have better rivers at home!" But his servants said, "If he asked you to do something hard, you would do it. Why not this easy thing?"

> So Naaman went down into the Jordan. One dip... two... three... four... five... six... **seven!** His skin became clean and soft like a little boy's. Naaman said, "Now I know there is no God in all the world except in Israel!"
>
> Sadly, most of the kings didn't listen to God. God sent prophet after prophet to warn them: "Turn back to Me!" But they wouldn't.
>
> Some kings did love God. **Josiah** became king when he was only **8 years old**! When he grew up, workers fixing the temple found a dusty scroll: God's Book of the Law! It had been lost. When Josiah heard it read, he tore his robes because his people had not obeyed God. Josiah cleaned out all the idols and led the people to worship God again.
>
> But after Josiah, the people turned away again. At last, the army of **Babylon** came. They burned the temple and took the people far away. It was very sad.
>
> But God was not done! Years later, someone wrote **Chronicles** to remind the people of their whole story, starting with Adam! It reminded them: "When God's people humble themselves and pray, God hears and forgives." The very end of Chronicles says that King Cyrus told God's people: "**Go home and rebuild!**" God always keeps His promises. And the forever King, Jesus, was still coming!

Age-group teaching tips

- **Little Lambs:** Count Naaman's seven dips together while a child "dips" (squats down and pops up). Celebrate on number 7!
- **Explorers:** Point out that Josiah was about their age when he became king. Read 2 Chronicles 34:3 ("while he was still young, he began to seek the God of his father David").
- **Trailblazers:** Build the timeline: Israel falls (722 BC), Judah falls (586 BC), Cyrus decree (538 BC). Explain Chronicles as a "replay" written after the exile.
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss 2 Chronicles 7:14 in context (spoken to Israel at the temple dedication). How do Christians apply it today without treating it as a promise about a modern nation? (Principle: God responds to humble repentance; 1 John 1:9.)

💬 **Discussion questions**

- *Little Lambs:* 1) How many times did Naaman dip in the river? (7) 2) How old was King Josiah? (8) 3) What did they find in the temple? (God's Book)
- *Explorers:* 1) Why was Naaman angry at first? 2) Who helped Naaman learn about Elisha? (A young servant girl) 3) What did Josiah do after hearing God's Word?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) Why did God let Babylon take His people away (2 Kings 17:13–14)? 2) Why do you think God's Book got "lost"? Can that happen to us? 3) What's the difference between Kings and Chronicles?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) Jesus mentioned Naaman in Luke 4:27. Why did that upset the crowd? (God's grace reaches outsiders.) 2) How does the end of 2 Kings (25:27–30) keep hope alive? 3) If Chronicles retells history to encourage people, how should we tell our own stories of failure and grace?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "Naaman" / "Elisha" / "Josiah" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Naaman | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Elisha" / "Naaman" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Elisha | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors | Likely title: "Overview: Chronicles"; bonus theme video "Exile" | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Chronicles |

Follow-up questions: 1) What happened to Naaman when he obeyed? 2) Why is Chronicles like a "replay"?

> Preview every video first.

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Seven Dips Relay* (see Games)

✂️ **Activity of the week:** *King Timeline Scroll* (see Activities & Crafts)

🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** Spell C-H-R-O-N-I-C-L-E-S ("Ch" says K!). Say all six books in order. Explorers and older: say all 14 books so far.

🙏 **Closing prayer**

> God, thank You for Your Book, the Bible. Help me never lose it, but read it and obey it like King Josiah. Thank You for keeping every promise. Amen.

Week 5 (optional): Royal Review Day

See **End-of-Phase Review & Celebration** below for the full plan. Kids wear crowns, play review games, recite the books, and receive the Heart Crown badge.

Book Memory Song & Motions

🎵 "The Kings and Kingdoms Song" (tune: *Yankee Doodle*)

This song is cumulative. Verse 1 is the 5 books of Law. Verse 2 adds Joshua, Judges and Ruth (learned in Phase 3) plus this month's six books, for 14 books in all.

Verse 1: The Law (books 1–5)

> Genesis and Exodus, Leviticus and Numbers, Deuteronomy makes five, The Law books, God's great wonders!

Shout: "FIVE BOOKS OF LAW!" *(hold up five fingers)*

Verse 2: History so far (books 6–14), sung to the chorus tune "Yankee Doodle, keep it up…"

> Joshua, Judges, Ruth, and then First, Second Samuel, First and Second Kings, and then First, Second Chronicles!

Tag line (spoken in rhythm):

> "Saul and David, Solomon, a kingdom split in two… But God's forever King is coming: Jesus, it's You!"

Shout: "NINE BOOKS OF HISTORY SO FAR!" *(hold up nine fingers)* **Big finish:** "FOURTEEN BOOKS! WE KNOW FOURTEEN!" *(all fingers twice, plus four)*

> Next month (Phase 5) adds Ezra, Nehemiah and Esther to finish all 12 History books.

Hand motions for each book

Book	Motion
Genesis	Sunrise hands: palms together like a closed book, open them, sweep arms up like the sun rising
Exodus	Exit walk: walk two fingers across your palm and out the "door"
Leviticus	Holy hands: fold hands to pray, then raise them high
Numbers	Count 1-2-3-4 on fingers, then zig-zag your hand (wandering)
Deuteronomy	Two fingers up ("second"), tap head ("remember"), hand on heart
Joshua	March in place with fist-trumpet at mouth ("Walls fall down!")
Judges	Pound a gavel on your palm, then draw a circle (the cycle)
Ruth	Scoop up pretend grain, then hug yourself (loyal love)
1 Samuel	1 finger up, then cup hand behind ear (listening)
2 Samuel	2 fingers up, then swing a pretend sling
1 Kings	1 finger up, then place a crown on your head
2 Kings	2 fingers up, then spin a finger like a whirlwind
1 Chronicles	1 finger up, then unroll a scroll
2 Chronicles	2 fingers up, then fold hands in prayer

📣 Section Shout

Leader: "What do we call the first five books?" Kids: "**The LAW!**" Leader: "What do we call Joshua through Chronicles?" Kids: "**HISTORY!**" Leader: "Who is the forever King?" Kids: "**JESUS!**"

Cumulative recall drill (2–3 minutes each week)

1. **Echo round:** Leader says a book, kids echo it with the motion.
2. **Motion only:** Leader does the motion silently; kids shout the book name.
3. **Missing book:** Leader says the list but skips one; first kid to name the missing book earns a "jewel" sticker for their crown.
4. **Pass the crown:** Kids sit in a circle passing a paper crown. Each child who holds it says the next book in order (Genesis → 2 Chronicles, then start over).
5. **Speed round (Trailblazers/Ambassadors):** Stopwatch: how fast can you say all 14 books? Record class best on the board.

Tips for each age group

- **Little Lambs:** Focus on the motions and the words "Samuel, Kings, Chronicles." They don't need to say all 14 alone. Hold up 1 and 2 fingers. Celebrate every attempt.
- **Explorers:** Aim to say all 14 in order. Use the song every week. Pair them with an Ambassador "coach."
- **Trailblazers:** Say all 14 without the song, and know which section each book belongs to. Challenge: say them backwards!
- **Ambassadors:** Lead the song and motions for younger groups. Know one key story for each of the six new books.

Spelling & Reading

Spelling lists by age group

Little Lambs (letter recognition and first sounds) | Word | First letter | Sound it out | |---|---|---| | Samuel | S | "Sss" like a snake 🐍 | | Kings | K | "K" like a kite | | David | D | "D" like a drum | | crown | C | "K" sound | | God | G | "G" like a goat | | heart | H | "H" like a happy breath |

Activity: Show big letter cards S, K, C, D. Ask "Which letter starts Samuel?" Kids trace the letters in the air or in a tray of sand/salt.

Explorers (book names)

1. Samuel (S-A-M-U-E-L)
2. Kings (K-I-N-G-S)
3. Chronicles (C-H-R-O-N-I-C-L-E-S)
4. David, Goliath, Solomon (bonus names) Practice writing "1 Samuel, 2 Samuel, 1 Kings, 2 Kings, 1 Chronicles, 2 Chronicles."

Trailblazers (book names + 5 vocab words)

- All six book names, plus Joshua, Judges, Ruth
- **prophet:** a person who brings God's message
- **anoint:** to pour oil on someone to show God has chosen them

- **temple:** God's house in Jerusalem, built by Solomon
- **kingdom:** a land and people ruled by a king
- **covenant:** a serious, binding promise between God and people

Ambassadors (book names + harder vocab with definitions)

- All 14 book names in order, spelled correctly
- **monarchy:** government by a king or queen
- **dynasty:** a line of rulers from the same family (the "house of David")
- **idolatry:** worshiping anything other than the true God
- **repentance:** turning away from sin and back to God
- **exile:** being forced to live away from your homeland
- **messiah:** Hebrew for "anointed one"; in Greek, "Christ"
- **chronicle:** a written record of events in time order (from the Greek *chronos*, "time")

Syllable-clap method

Clap once per syllable as you say the word, then spell it:

- Sam-u-el (3 claps) → S-A-M-U-E-L
- Kings (1 clap) → K-I-N-G-S
- Chron-i-cles (3 claps) → C-H-R-O-N-I-C-L-E-S
- Go-li-ath (3 claps) → G-O-L-I-A-T-H
- Sol-o-mon (3 claps) → S-O-L-O-M-O-N
- E-li-jah (3 claps) → E-L-I-J-A-H
- E-li-sha (3 claps) → E-L-I-S-H-A

Tip: "Elijah" and "Elisha" only differ at the end: **J-A-H** vs **S-H-A**. Remember: **J** comes before **S** in the alphabet, and Elijah came before Elisha. Elisha has the **S** for "**S**econd prophet."

"Spell It Out" relay

1. Split into teams of 4–6. Each team lines up behind a starting line.
2. Across the room, place a pile of letter cards for each team (enough letters to spell SAMUEL, KINGS and CHRONICLES).
3. Leader calls a book: "Chronicles!" The first runner grabs the first letter (C), runs back, and tags the next runner, who gets the next letter (H), and so on.
4. The team lays the letters in order on the floor. First team to spell the word correctly and shout it wins the round.
5. *Younger:* Use only first letters, or let them carry a whole word card. *Older:* add the number (a "1" or "2" card) and spell names like GOLIATH and NAAMAN.

Mini spelling bee word list

Word	Use it in a sentence
Samuel	Samuel heard God calling him in the night.

Word	Use it in a sentence
Kings	The books of Kings tell about the kings of Israel and Judah.
Chronicles	Chronicles starts with a family tree from Adam.
David	David was a shepherd boy who became king.
Goliath	Goliath was a giant from the city of Gath.
Solomon	Solomon asked God for wisdom.
Elijah	Elijah prayed, and fire fell from heaven.
Elisha	Elisha told Naaman to wash seven times.
temple	Solomon built a temple for God in Jerusalem.
prophet	A prophet tells people God's message.
Jerusalem	David made Jerusalem his capital city.
Naaman	Naaman was healed in the Jordan River.

Read-aloud practice passage

Have readers take turns reading one sentence each (simple version based on 1 Samuel 16:6–7, 11–13):

> When they came, Samuel saw Eliab. He thought, "Surely this is the one the LORD has chosen." But the LORD said to Samuel, "Do not look at how tall he is. People look at the outside. But the LORD looks at the heart." Then Samuel asked Jesse, "Are these all the sons you have?" Jesse said, "There is still the youngest. He is taking care of the sheep." So they brought David. The LORD said, "Rise and anoint him. This is the one." So Samuel poured oil on David's head.

Word Trivia

⭐ Easy (Little Lambs / Explorers)

1. Who called Samuel in the night?
2. What animal did David take care of?
3. What was the name of the giant David fought?
4. How many stones did David pick up?
5. What did Solomon ask God for?
6. What did Solomon build for God?
7. What fell from heaven when Elijah prayed?
8. What birds brought food to Elijah?
9. How many times did Naaman dip in the river?
10. **True or False:** God looks at how tall we are.
11. **Fill in the blank:** "The LORD looks at the ____."
12. Who is the forever King from David's family?

⭐⭐ Medium (Explorers / Trailblazers)

13. Who was Israel's first king?
14. What was the name of Samuel's mother?
15. **Who said it?** "Speak, for your servant is listening."
16. Who was David's best friend (Saul's son)?
17. **Which book?** David and Goliath are found in ____.
18. What city did David make his capital?
19. **True or False:** The kingdom split into two kingdoms after Solomon died.
20. What were the two kingdoms called?
21. On what mountain did Elijah face the prophets of Baal?
22. **Who said it?** "The LORD — he is God!"
23. In what river did Naaman wash?
24. How did Elijah go to heaven?
25. **Which book?** The prayer of Jabez is in ____.

⭐⭐⭐ Hard (Trailblazers / Ambassadors)

26. How many prophets of Baal were on Mount Carmel?
27. **Who said it?** "You come against me with sword and spear and javelin, but I come against you in the name of the LORD Almighty."
28. What prophet told David a story about a poor man's lamb?
29. What was the name of Jonathan's son who couldn't walk, to whom David showed kindness?
30. **Fill in the blank:** "If my people, who are called by my name, will ____ themselves and pray..." (2 Chronicles 7:14)
31. Which empire conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC?
32. Which empire destroyed Jerusalem and the temple in 586 BC?
33. How old was Josiah when he became king?
34. **Which book?** God's promise that David's throne will be established forever is in 2 Samuel chapter ____.
35. Which Persian king's decree ends 2 Chronicles?
36. **True or False:** Chronicles was written before Samuel and Kings.
37. What did Elisha ask Elijah for before Elijah was taken up?
38. Who was the first king of the northern kingdom after the split?

Answer Key

1. God 2. Sheep 3. Goliath 4. Five 5. Wisdom (a wise heart) 6. A temple 7. Fire 8. Ravens 9. Seven 10. False, He looks at the heart 11. heart 12. Jesus
2. Saul 14. Hannah 15. Samuel (1 Samuel 3:10) 16. Jonathan 17. 1 Samuel (ch. 17) 18. Jerusalem 19. True 20. Israel (north) and Judah (south) 21. Mount Carmel 22. The people of Israel (1 Kings 18:39) 23. The Jordan River 24. In a whirlwind, with a chariot and horses of fire (2 Kings 2:11) 25. 1 Chronicles (4:9–10)
3. 450 (plus 400 prophets of Asherah were invited, 1 Kings 18:19) 27. David, to Goliath (1 Samuel 17:45) 28. Nathan (2 Samuel 12) 29. Mephibosheth (2 Samuel 9) 30. humble 31. Assyria 32. Babylon 33. Eight (2 Kings 22:1) 34. 7 (2 Samuel 7:16) 35. Cyrus 36. False. Chronicles was written

after the exile, later than Samuel and Kings. 37. A double portion of his spirit (2 Kings 2:9) 38. Jeroboam (1 Kings 12:20)

Games

> More game ideas and general rules: see `../00-start-here/game-library.md`.

🎮 1. Crown Grab

- **Best for:** Explorers, Trailblazers (Little Lambs with help)
- **Supplies:** One paper or plastic crown, masking tape
- **Setup:** Two teams line up facing each other about 20 feet apart. Each player on both teams is secretly given a book name (Genesis through 2 Chronicles, 14 books), so each team has one player per book (repeat books for big teams). The crown sits in the middle.
- **How to play:** The leader calls a clue, such as "the book where David fights Goliath" or "the book after Ruth." The two players holding "1 Samuel" race to grab the crown and bring it back without being tagged by the other.
- **How to win:** One point for bringing the crown back safely; one point to the tagger if they tag. First team to 10.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* Just call out the book name and hold up a picture. *Older:* Give clues from summaries ("the book that ends with Cyrus's decree").
- **Learning goal:** Book order and book contents.

🎮 2. Giant Toss

- **Best for:** All ages
- **Supplies:** A large poster of Goliath (draw on butcher paper, about 6–9 feet tall, taped to a wall), 5 beanbags or soft balls ("smooth stones"), sticky notes with the 14 book names stuck on different parts of the giant
- **Setup:** Mark a throwing line about 8–12 feet away (closer for Little Lambs).
- **How to play:** Each child gets 5 "stones." When a throw hits a sticky note, the child reads the book name aloud and says the book that comes *next*. Hitting Goliath's forehead (a special star) = shout the memory verse for a bonus.
- **How to win:** Teams earn 1 point per correct "next book" and 3 points for the forehead verse. Highest team score wins, but remind kids: "The battle is the LORD's!"
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* Any hit counts; teacher reads the name and kids repeat. *Older:* Must say the next TWO books, or give the section and one fact.
- **Learning goal:** Book order and the memory verse.

🎮 3. Kingdom Split Tag

- **Best for:** Explorers, Trailblazers, Ambassadors

- **Supplies:** Two colors of pinnies or armbands (blue = Israel, purple = Judah), cones to divide the room
- **Setup:** Divide the play area in half: north (Israel) and south (Judah). Put 10 "tribe" players on the north side and 2 or 3 on the south (or a proportion of your class: more in the north).
- **How to play:** The leader calls out a king or prophet fact. If the fact is about the north (Israel: Jeroboam, Ahab, Elijah, Samaria), southern players can tag northern players. If it's about the south (Judah: Rehoboam, Hezekiah, Josiah, Jerusalem, temple), northern players can tag southern players. Tagged players freeze and must answer a book-order question to be "freed."
- **How to win:** No winner: play several rounds and see who can stay unfrozen longest. Or the team with the fewest frozen at the end.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* Simple "Red light, green light" with "Good king!" (walk) and "Bad king!" (freeze). *Older:* Use harder facts ("first king of the north," "capital of Israel").
- **Learning goal:** Understanding the divided kingdom, kings and prophets.

🎮 4. Seven Dips Relay

- **Best for:** All ages
- **Supplies:** A blue tarp or blue paper strip ("the Jordan River"), 7 index cards per team with one of the 14 book names (mix them), a cone for each team
- **Setup:** Teams line up. Across the room is the "Jordan River."
- **How to play:** Each runner runs to the river, does a "dip" (a squat) while saying the next book in order on their turn (Runner 1: "Genesis," Runner 2: "Exodus"...), and runs back. The team must get to 7 dips, then 14 (all books), in correct order. If someone says the wrong book, the team says "Try again, Naaman!" and that runner dips again.
- **How to win:** First team to complete all 14 books in order and shout "I'm clean!" wins.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* Just count to 7 dips together. *Older:* Go backwards from 2 Chronicles to Genesis.
- **Learning goal:** Book order; the Naaman story (obeying God fully).

🎮 5. Throne Swap (book-name musical chairs, no one is "out")

- **Best for:** Little Lambs, Explorers
- **Supplies:** Chairs in a circle (one per child), a book-name card taped to each chair, music
- **Setup:** Chairs face outward with book cards on the seats.
- **How to play:** Play music (try a worship song or the Yankee Doodle book song). When the music stops, everyone sits in a "throne." The leader picks a child to read (or say, with help) the book on their seat and do its motion. Everyone stays in. Remove no chairs.
- **How to win:** Everyone wins a "jewel" sticker when the whole group gets through all 14 books.
- **Adaptations:** *Older:* Remove one chair each round; the child without a chair must say all books on the seats in order to rejoin.
- **Learning goal:** Recognizing and reading book names.

🎮 6. Fire or Fizzle? (true/false run)

- **Best for:** All ages
- **Supplies:** Two signs: "FIRE! 🔥 (True)" on one wall and "FIZZLE 💧 (False)" on the opposite wall

- **How to play:** Leader reads a statement ("Solomon asked for riches" / "Josiah was 8 when he became king"). Kids run to the wall they think is right. Explain each answer.
- **How to win:** Kids on the correct side get a point; play to 10.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* Use very simple statements and picture cues. *Older:* Use the Hard trivia.
- **Learning goal:** Story facts and review.

Coloring Pages

> 🖍️ Printable book-name coloring sheet and word search: see `../printables/phase-04-printables.html`

Page 1 (Week 1): "Speak, LORD, I'm Listening"

- **Scene:** A boy (Samuel) sitting up on a simple mat in a lamp-lit room, with a small clay oil lamp glowing. One hand is behind his ear. Through a doorway you can see the old priest Eli sleeping. Soft lines of light come from above.
- **Caption:** "Speak, for your servant is listening." (1 Samuel 3:10)
- **Conversation prompts:** How do you think Samuel felt when he heard his name? How does God speak to us today? (Through the Bible, through prayer, through people who love Him.)

Page 2 (Week 2): "The Battle Is the LORD's"

- **Scene:** Young David in a simple tunic, swinging a sling over his head, a shepherd's bag at his waist and a stream with smooth stones at his feet. In the background, huge Goliath (shown from the waist up, big helmet and spear) towers over the hill. Scared soldiers peek from behind rocks.
- **Caption:** "The LORD looks at the heart." (1 Samuel 16:7)
- **Conversation prompts:** What is something that feels like a "giant" to you? Who can help you be brave?

Page 3 (Week 3): "The LORD, He Is God!"

- **Scene:** Elijah with arms raised beside an altar of 12 large stones surrounded by a water-filled ditch. Big flames come down from the sky onto the altar. People on the mountainside fall to their knees.
- **Caption:** "The LORD — he is God!" (1 Kings 18:39)
- **Conversation prompts:** Why did Elijah pour water on the altar? What would you have shouted if you were there?

Page 4 (Week 4): "Seven Dips"

- **Scene:** Naaman in the Jordan River, coming up from the water with a big smile. Number bubbles 1 through 7 float in the air above him. His horses and chariot wait on the riverbank with servants cheering.

- **Caption:** "Now I know that there is no God in all the world except in Israel." (2 Kings 5:15)
- **Conversation prompts:** Was it hard for Naaman to obey? What is something God asks you to do that might be hard?

Page 5 (Week 4 bonus): "Boy King Josiah"

- **Scene:** An 8-year-old king with a too-big crown, sitting on a throne, holding an unrolled scroll. A priest stands beside him pointing at the words.
- **Caption:** "While he was still young, he began to seek the God of his father David." (2 Chronicles 34:3)
- **Conversation prompts:** What can kids do for God? How can you "seek God" this week?

Page 6 (Book-name page): "Six Royal Books"

- **Scene:** Six crowns in two rows of three. Each crown has a book name in bubble letters: 1 SAMUEL, 2 SAMUEL, 1 KINGS, 2 KINGS, 1 CHRONICLES, 2 CHRONICLES. Under each is a tiny symbol (ear, sling, split crown, whirlwind, scroll, praying hands). A big banner across the top reads "HISTORY."
- **Caption:** "Jesus is the forever King!"
- **Conversation prompts:** Which crown is your favorite book? Can you say all six in order while you color?

Activities & Crafts

✂️ 1. Heart Crown craft (Week 1)

- **Supplies:** Purple or gold cardstock crown strips (about 4" × 24"), red foam or paper hearts, sticky "jewels," glue sticks, stapler, markers
- **Steps:**
    1. Cut points along the top edge of the strip (precut for Little Lambs).
    2. Write "The LORD looks at the heart" on the front band.
    3. Glue a big red heart in the center.
    4. Decorate with jewels: one jewel for each book they can say.
    5. Staple to fit each child's head.
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* precut crowns; teacher writes the verse; kids decorate. *Explorers:* write the six new book names on the points. *Trailblazers:* write a "heart quality" on each point (honest, kind, brave, obedient…). *Ambassadors:* make crowns for the Little Lambs and help them.
- **What it teaches:** God chooses based on the heart; kids belong to the King.

✂️ 2. Five Smooth Stones (Week 2)

- **Supplies:** Smooth river rocks (from a craft store) or gray paper "stones," paint pens or permanent markers, a small fabric bag or paper lunch bag
- **Steps:**
    1. Give each child five stones.

2. Write one word or phrase of the memory verse on each stone: "People look... outward appearance... but the LORD... looks at... the heart."
3. Mix them up and practice putting them in order.
4. Put them in a "shepherd's bag" to take home.

- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* write the 5 words "The / LORD / looks / at / heart" or draw a heart, eye, crown, sheep and sling. *Older groups:* on the back of each stone, write one of this month's books (1 Samuel through 1 Chronicles), and on the bag write a "giant" they want to trust God with (privately, if they prefer).
- **What it teaches:** Memorizing the verse; trusting God with our "giants."

✂️ 3. Elijah's 12-Stone Altar (Week 3)

- **Supplies:** 12 small boxes, blocks or stacked paper cups per team; red, orange and yellow tissue paper; a blue paper "ditch" ring; a small cup of water (optional, outside)
- **Steps:**
  1. Label the 12 stones with the 12 tribes, or with the first 12 books of the Bible (Genesis → 2 Kings)!
  2. Build an altar.
  3. Place the blue ring around it as the ditch.
  4. Crumple tissue "fire" and toss it on top when everyone shouts, "The LORD — He is God!"
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* big soft blocks, count to 12 together. *Explorers:* use the first 12 book names and build in order. *Trailblazers/Ambassadors:* label with the 12 tribes (Reuben, Simeon, Levi, Judah, Dan, Naphtali, Gad, Asher, Issachar, Zebulun, Joseph, Benjamin) and discuss why Elijah used 12 even though the kingdom was split (he reminded them they were one people of God).
- **What it teaches:** God alone is God; God answers prayer; book order.

✂️ 4. King Timeline Scroll (Week 4)

- **Supplies:** Long strips of paper (adding-machine tape or butcher paper cut 4" wide, about 4 feet long), two dowels or paper towel tubes, crayons, tape, simple picture cards (Samuel, Saul, David, Solomon, split crown, Elijah, Elisha, Josiah, Babylon, Cyrus)
- **Steps:**
  1. Draw a line across the strip.
  2. Glue or draw the picture cards in order along the line.
  3. Label the dates (older groups): 1050 BC Saul; 1010 David; 970 Solomon; 930 split; 722 Israel falls; 586 Judah falls; 538 Cyrus.
  4. Tape each end to a tube and roll it up like a "chronicle" scroll.
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* 4 pictures only (Samuel, David, Solomon, Elijah). *Explorers:* all pictures, no dates. *Trailblazers:* add dates and which book tells each part. *Ambassadors:* add the prophets of each period (Elijah, Elisha, Isaiah, Jeremiah), linking to Phase 7.
- **What it teaches:** The order of Israel's history; Chronicles as a "record in time."

✂️ 5. Mephibosheth's Table Place Mat

- **Supplies:** 11" × 17" construction paper, markers, laminator or clear contact paper

- **Steps:**
  1. Draw a long royal table with a seat that says "Reserved for ____ (your name)."
  2. Write: "Jesus invites me to His table."
  3. Decorate with food, crowns and the six book names around the border.
  4. Laminate to use at home.
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* sticker food and name written by a teacher. *Older:* add 2 Samuel 9:7, "I will surely show you kindness."
- **What it teaches:** Grace: the King brings us to His table though we don't deserve it.

✂️ 6. Naaman Seven-Dip Flip Book

- **Supplies:** 8 small paper squares stapled together, crayons
- **Steps:** Page 1: Naaman with spots. Pages 2–7: numbers 1–6 with fewer spots each time. Page 8: "7!" Naaman clean and smiling with the words "God healed me!"
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* use precut pages and dot stickers to peel off. *Older:* add the lesson "Obey God all the way."
- **What it teaches:** Obedience and God's power to heal.

Word Puzzles

Word scramble

Unscramble these words from this month's stories. | # | Scrambled | Hint | |---|---|---| | 1 | LEUMAS | A prophet who heard God at night | | 2 | VIDAD | Shepherd boy who became king | | 3 | THAILOG | A giant | | 4 | MONOLOS | The wise king | | 5 | JHALIE | Prophet on Mount Carmel | | 6 | SAHILE | Prophet who helped Naaman | | 7 | GINKS | 1 and 2 ____ | | 8 | ELCHORNICS | 1 and 2 ____ | | 9 | PELMET | God's house in Jerusalem | | 10 | WRONC | A king wears it | | 11 | THEPORP | Person who tells God's message | | 12 | MAANAN | Captain healed in the Jordan | | 13 | HISAJO | Boy king who found God's Book | | 14 | HAHNNA | Samuel's mother |

Answer key: 1. SAMUEL 2. DAVID 3. GOLIATH 4. SOLOMON 5. ELIJAH 6. ELISHA 7. KINGS 8. CHRONICLES 9. TEMPLE 10. CROWN 11. PROPHET 12. NAAMAN 13. JOSIAH 14. HANNAH

Fill-in-the-blank story

Word bank: *heart, Goliath, stones, wisdom, temple, fire, seven, forever, Jesus, Book*

> God sent Samuel to choose a new king. God said, "The LORD looks at the _____." He chose David, a shepherd boy. David trusted God and fought the giant _____ with a sling and five smooth _____. God promised David that his family would have a King _____. David's son Solomon asked God for _____ and built a beautiful _____. Later, Elijah prayed, and _____ fell from heaven. Naaman dipped _____ times in the Jordan River and was healed. Boy King Josiah found God's lost _____ in the temple. All these stories point to the forever King, _____!

Answer key: heart, Goliath, stones, forever, wisdom, temple, fire, seven, Book, Jesus

Match the book to its picture / summary

Draw a line from the book to its matching picture and summary. | Book | | Picture & summary | |---|---|---| | 1. 1 Samuel | | A. 🌪️ Elijah goes up in a whirlwind; Naaman is healed; the kingdoms fall. | | 2. 2 Samuel | | B. 🙏 Solomon's temple; "If my people… pray"; Cyrus says go home. | | 3. 1 Kings | | C. 👂 Samuel listens; Saul is first king; David beats Goliath. | | 4. 2 Kings | | D. 📜 A family tree from Adam; David prepares for the temple. | | 5. 1 Chronicles | | E. 🤝 David is king; God promises a forever throne; kindness to Mephibosheth. | | 6. 2 Chronicles | | F. ✂️👑 Solomon's wisdom; the kingdom splits; fire on Mount Carmel. |

Answer key: 1-C, 2-E, 3-F, 4-A, 5-D, 6-B

Questions for Every Age

Little Lambs (ages 4–6)

1. What does God look at? (Our heart)
2. Who can help you be brave like David?
3. What can you ask God for, like Solomon? (To help you be wise and good)
4. Can God hear you when you pray? (Yes!)
5. Who is the best King of all? (Jesus)

Explorers (ages 7–10)

1. What is one way you can listen to God this week?
2. What's a "giant" (something scary or hard) you can trust God with?
3. How can you show kindness like David showed Mephibosheth?
4. If God offered you anything, what would you ask for? Why?
5. Josiah was young when he started following God. What is one thing you can do for God right now?

Trailblazers (ages 11–13)

1. Why do people judge by outward appearance? Where do you see that at school?
2. What are some "fake gods" people trust instead of the real God?
3. Saul looked good but disobeyed. What's the difference between looking religious and loving God?
4. Why do you think so many kings turned away from God even after seeing miracles?
5. How does knowing Jesus is the forever King help when leaders let you down?

Ambassadors (ages 14–17)

1. David was "a man after God's own heart" (Acts 13:22) yet sinned terribly. What does that teach you about God's grace and about our heroes?
2. Solomon had wisdom but didn't use it at the end. Where are you tempted to know the right thing and not do it?
3. The people wanted to be "like all the other nations." In what ways do Christian teens feel pressure to fit in?
4. How does 2 Samuel 7 shape the way you read the New Testament (e.g., Matthew 1:1; Luke 1:32–33; Romans 1:3)?
5. Elijah later felt alone and wanted to give up (1 Kings 19). What did God do for him, and what does that teach about discouragement?

Big Questions for Ambassadors (apologetics / worldview)

1. **"Is there any evidence King David existed?"** *Suggested answer:* Yes. The Tel Dan Stele, found in northern Israel in 1993–94 and dated to the 800s BC, mentions the "House of David," meaning a dynasty named after David. This is outside the Bible and written by an enemy king. Many other names from Kings (such as Omri, Ahab, Jehu, Hezekiah and Sennacherib) also appear in Assyrian and Moabite records. Archaeology doesn't "prove" faith, but it shows the Bible is rooted in real history.
2. **"Why does the Bible show its heroes' sins so plainly?"** *Suggested answer:* Ancient royal records usually bragged and hid failures. The Bible tells the truth about Saul, David and Solomon, which is one sign that it is honest history and not propaganda. It also makes the main point clear: no human king can save us. We need a perfect King, Jesus.
3. **"If God is in control, why did He let His people be conquered?"** *Suggested answer:* God warned His people for hundreds of years through prophets (2 Kings 17:13–14). The exile was both a consequence of their choices and a discipline meant to bring them back. Even in exile, God preserved David's line (2 Kings 25:27–30) and later brought them home (2 Chronicles 36:22–23). God's judgment and mercy work together, and both point to the cross, where Jesus took the judgment so we could have mercy.

End-of-Phase Review & Celebration

Royal Review Day plan (last Sunday of the month, 75 minutes)

Time	What happens
0–10 min	**Royal Welcome:** Kids put on their Heart Crowns. Play the Kings & Kingdoms song with motions. Ambassadors act as "royal heralds" who greet each child with "Welcome to the King's court!"
10–25 min	**Story Replay ("Chronicles Theater"):** Four stations, one per week's story. Small groups rotate every 3–4 minutes and act out a 1-minute scene (Samuel listening, David and Goliath, Elijah's fire, Naaman's dips).

Time	What happens
25–35 min	**Favorite Video Rewatch:** Let the kids vote on the best clip from the month.
35–50 min	**Royal Bible Bowl:** Teams answer trivia from the Word Trivia list. Use buzzers (or bells). Little Lambs answer picture questions with help.
50–60 min	**Game:** Giant Toss or Throne Swap (kids' choice)
60–70 min	**Oral check-off + Royal Feast:** While kids enjoy a snack ("Mephibosheth's table": grapes, crackers, cheese, "crown" cookies), teachers do individual check-offs. *(Check allergies first.)*
70–75 min	**Badge Ceremony & Prayer:** Stamp Bible Passports, award Heart Crown badges, pray.

Oral check-off checklist

Little Lambs (ages 4–6)

- ☐ Says "History" when asked what kind of books these are
- ☐ Names 3 of this month's books (e.g., Samuel, Kings, Chronicles), with or without numbers
- ☐ Says the short verse: "The LORD looks at the heart."
- ☐ Tells one thing about David, Elijah or Naaman

Explorers (ages 7–10)

- ☐ Says all 6 books of this phase in order
- ☐ Spells SAMUEL, KINGS and CHRONICLES correctly
- ☐ Says the books from Genesis to 2 Chronicles (14) with the song
- ☐ Says the full memory verse (1 Samuel 16:7)

Trailblazers (ages 11–13)

- ☐ Says all 14 books so far in order without the song
- ☐ Gives a one-sentence summary of each of the 6 new books
- ☐ Identifies the two sections (Law, History)
- ☐ Says the memory verse with reference

Ambassadors (ages 14–17)

- ☐ Says all 14 books in order and can name the section of each
- ☐ Explains the Davidic covenant (2 Samuel 7) and how it points to Jesus
- ☐ Teaches one of the six books to a younger child (2 minutes: name, motion, one story)
- ☐ Says the memory verse with reference

🛂 Bible Passport stamp

Stamp the "Kings & Kingdoms" page of each child's Bible Passport. Stamp design: a purple crown with "1 SAM – 2 CHRON" around the edge. Kids who complete the check-off get a gold star next to the stamp.

🏅 Badge description: The Heart Crown Badge

A round purple badge with a gold crown in the center and a small red heart on the front of the crown. Around the edge: "KINGS & KINGDOMS • 14 OF 66." (Use a sticker, a pin-back button, or an iron-on patch for a sash.)

📜 Certificate wording

> **Royal Court Certificate** This certifies that _____ has completed **Phase 4: Kings & Kingdoms** at Purpose Church Sunday School. You have learned the books of **1 Samuel, 2 Samuel, 1 Kings, 2 Kings, 1 Chronicles and 2 Chronicles** and now know **14 of the 66 books** of the Bible! *"People look at the outward appearance, but the LORD looks at the heart." (1 Samuel 16:7)* Remember: Jesus is the forever King, and He looks at your heart with love. Teacher: _____ Date: _____

Take-Home Family Page

> ✂️ *Copy this page and send it home on the first Sunday of the month.*

Dear Parents and Caregivers, This month your child is learning **Phase 4: Kings & Kingdoms**, six History books of the Bible: **1 Samuel, 2 Samuel, 1 Kings, 2 Kings, 1 Chronicles and 2 Chronicles.** We'll meet Samuel, King Saul, David and Goliath, wise King Solomon, the prophet Elijah, Naaman, and boy King Josiah. The big idea: **God looks at the heart, and He keeps His promise of a forever King, Jesus.** Your child now knows **14 of the 66 books** of the Bible!

📖 **Memory Verse:** "People look at the outward appearance, but the LORD looks at the heart." (1 Samuel 16:7, NIV) **Little Lambs:** "The LORD looks at the heart."

🎵 **Our Song (tune: *Yankee Doodle*)**

> Genesis and Exodus, Leviticus and Numbers, Deuteronomy makes five, the Law books, God's great wonders! Joshua, Judges, Ruth, and then First, Second Samuel, First and Second Kings, and then First, Second Chronicles!

🍽️ **Dinner-table questions**

1. What is something people notice about the outside, and what is something only God sees on the inside?
2. If God said, "Ask for anything," what would you ask for? What did Solomon ask for?
3. What "giant" is our family facing right now, and how can we trust God with it together?

🏠 **Family activity: "Heart Look" game** Over dinner, each person says one thing they love about another family member's *heart* (kindness, helpfulness, honesty), not their looks or skills. Then read 1 Samuel 16:7 together and pray for each other.

📺 **Videos to watch at home (search on YouTube; parents, please preview)**

- @SharefaithKids: search "David and Goliath" → https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=David+and+Goliath
- @BibleJourneyTV: search "Elijah" → https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Elijah
- @bibleproject: "Overview: 1 Samuel," "Overview: 2 Samuel," "Overview: 1-2 Kings," "Overview: Chronicles" → https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Samuel

Thank you for partnering with us! For more about the program, see `../00-start-here/program-overview.md`.